1 O'Neill
QDR:10085

Example of a manually abstracted transcript: Celia

What are your experiences of being a high performance athlete and being at school?

It's really hard sometimes to get my homework done. When I come home at night at 7.30pm I get into a shower, then eat my dinner then it's about 8.15pm. I don't want to do homework then. It's hard to motivate to do my homework at 8.30pm at night and so I have to put in extra hours to do my homework, especially on the weekends. But the weekends are when I really would like to socialise...but I have to do my homework.

At school I have two double spares a week. So that really helps with getting my homework done. I don't have to do it at night now as I have got these two double spares in the school week. Now I can just relax or do whatever I want, like face book. It definitely helps the spares as I have 90 minutes of just doing schoolwork sitting in the library. It's quiet and I can just focus and do all my homework and assignments and whatever I need to do for my day, read a book or whatever. It just really, really helps me.

homework

motivation problem
tired

extra hours
Weekend.

socialise
homework } tension

Spare time allocated
at school

relax at evenings
Spare time
quiet & focus

help

Note!
She is so tired in this interview
Tension

put into practice

the gym in the afternoon from school and then come home, go to sleep, wake up and start it all over again...not much social life really. I think I cope very well but I'm not as high up in gymnastics like I haven't made the Commonwealth team or Olympic team yet. But my mum and dad are so helpful so that makes it easier for me to get my schoolwork done and train

The school is really helpful as I have already mentioned at our school there are a lots of high performance athletes so they are really aware of the needs of high performance athletes. So I think they are really good.

You mentioned about a lot of high performance athletes at your school?

Oh yes, there is so many of us. Maybe one thing our school could do to help us more is to decrease the amount of homework, as this may benefit the athlete student. If you are going to focus on sport like my high performance swimmer friend, to do the basics would be good. Just to get a good mark to get you into say our local university would be good. So then you could focus on your sport and know you have the opportunity to get into a degree with your okay mark after Year 12. But for someone like me, I won't be doing gym for too much longer because of my age in this sport. So I need to be able to do a bit of everything so I can finish school with a good mark to further my studies after school. I've done gym my whole life so I don't know what I will do without it...so knowing some options after I finish in 2 years time would be pretty worthwhile.

Coming to the end of our interview, is there anything else you would like to mention?

It just helps if you have supportive people around you who are willing to help you. A willing school that you can tell them

You mentioned spares?

Our school is really helpful, so if you do a lot of sport, as our school has a lot of high performance athletes, the school is really helpful on providing extra hours to go to school early to see the teachers and after school. Everyone is just so willing to help you and everyone makes it good.

If you miss out on work you can email the teacher and they will email you back. You can go and see them at lunchtime; you can pretty much see them anytime you want. They care. They don't mind if you are taking up their lunchtime or morning tea time. They will even come in earlier in the morning or later in the afternoon to talk to you or help you to get your work done or if you are not understanding. They just help you to get your work done or go through the assignments. They are really good for me and I find I go at lunchtime to talk to teachers* then as I don't have the time after school to go see them.

As a high performance school-age athlete what do you see as the problems of doing school and high performance sport at the same time?

Probleem

Tendency procrastinate

Probably for me it is handing in assignments on time. As I mentioned before, it's hard for me to motivate myself to do my homework when I get home late. I put things off; I push it aside to the end of the week ad before I know it I'm cramming it all in. I often leave it to the last night and them it is really hard for me to get my homework done on time. This is just me...some other older high performance athletes I know and see at my school do their homework and assignments way before or they get on top of it and they are not like me as I'm a bit slack on that. I think it helps if you have organisational skills and are organised with your school work. This definitely would be good for me to balance my sport and schoolwork. Pretty much my life is school and gymnastics. I go to school, go straight to

about your experiences and if you do a lot of sport make sure people are aware of your situation. Most definitely having people that help you and are supportive of what you are trying to achieve is the best thing for me for both sport and completing my schooling

Support

Need: Need to communicate

At the start of this year I dropped a subject and I went to see the subject co-ordinator and I told him about how many hours I train and what level I was at in my gymnastics, I explained to him why I needed to drop a subject and he was fine about that...so you just have to tell the school about what you are doing and they are more than willing to assist you in doing your sport and schoolwork at the same time

Dropping subject. inform school commitments

inform school/coach commitments. willingness to assist

Only sometimes some mean girls do bully me…Like calling me mean names… but they are just jealous.
Mostly the girls I go to the school with are my friends. I just learnt who surround myself with.

Bullying